

Persist Week of May 4, 2026

REMINDER: Persist is no longer accessible through ATOM. To continue using Persist, you must log in through our new app. If you have not received your login instructions or are experiencing any issues, please contact us at support@functional-bodybuilding.com

We will continue to send a PDF version of training in our Persist only weekly newsletters.

This document may be created in advance of edits to the ongoing tracks in Persist, so while we try to minimize these discrepancies as much as possible, the version displayed in our app is always the most up to date. As always, please reach out using the chat bubble in our FBB app or on our website at <https://functional-bodybuilding.com> if you have any questions about the programming. It may be helpful to look over the week ahead to make sure your questions are all answered in time for your workout.

Pump Lift 5x

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Pump Lift 3x

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Pump Lift 5x

Monday, May 4th, 2026

Week 1 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Box Squat

The box squat is one of our primary squat variations this block. The reduced range of motion allows for heavier loads, and we'll decrease reps every other week so you can continue adding weight across the six-week progression.

When selecting box height, aim for about parallel. Lower isn't always better here.

Short on time? Remove Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min):

3 Rounds

90 sec Cardio of Choice

Goblet Heel Sits; 10 reps

Ring Assisted Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side

Dual KB Rack March; 30 seconds

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):

Box Squat

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 -- 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12-15 min):

Toes Elevated DB RDL

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

E) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets

Bent Knee Copenhagen Raise; 8 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 60 sec

2. Goblet Cyclist Squat; 8 reps @21X1 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (8-10 min):

2-3 sets

Wall Leaning Double Calf Raise; 10-15 reps @ 31X1 Tempo

rest 30 sec

2. Bent Hollow Hold; 20-30sec

rest 30-60 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note;

Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Foot Elevated Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side

Dynamic Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side

Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side

Tuesday, May 5th, 2026

Week 1 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Strict Press Progression

This block alternates between the DB strict press and the back supported barbell strict press. Each one enhances the other – the DB press demands more coordination and works each side

individually, while the back supported barbell press provides stability so you can prioritize moving heavier loads.

Short on time? Remove Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

3 Sets

Prone BTN Press; 6-8 reps

Ring Y Row; 6-8 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):

Dumbbell Strict Press

4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 15 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 12 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12-15 min):

Strict Bar Dip

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 30X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 2 - 10 reps @ 30X0 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 3 - 8 reps @ 30X0 Tempo - RPE 10

E) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets

Incline DB Fly; 10-12 reps @ 30X0

directly into

2. Incline DB Bench Press; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

directly into

3. Incline Narrow Grip Bench Press; 10-12 reps @ 30X0

rest 2min and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure. Use the same weight for three movements. Adjust Tempo if needed so that you can use the same weight for all movements.

F) Finisher (8-10 min):

2-3 sets

Dumbbell SkullCrushers; 10-12 reps @21X1

rest 30 sec

2. Plank; 30-40sec

rest 90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Theraband Around the World; 6-10 reps

Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec

PVC Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30-60 sec

Wednesday, May 6th, 2026

Week 1 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Density Sets

The strength intensity section uses a high density format – six sets of six reps with only 30–45 seconds of rest. Weight selection is key. Choose a load you could perform for about 12–15 reps when fresh. If you're using Pull Ups, apply the same idea with your level of assistance.

If you start struggling to complete full reps toward the end, that's fine. Continue with partial reps through as much range of motion as you can. That will still produce a very strong stimulus.

Short on time? Remove Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

3 Sets

Banded Goodmorning; 10-15 reps

DB Chainsaw Row; 6-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):

6 sets; rest 30-45sec rest between sets

Supinated Lat Pulldown or Supinated Strict Pull Up; 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo

Loading Note:

If using Pull Ups instead of pulldowns, match band or machine assistance to prescription. This is a high density format, meaning a lot of reps with little rest. Select a weight or band assistance that is consistent with 12-15 rep max for the prescribed movement. RPE for set 1 should be at about a 6 as this will get more challenging with each set.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12-15 min):

Incline Prone Dumbbell Row

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 15 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 12 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets

RNT Single Arm DB Row; 10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 30 sec

2. DB Bent Over Reverse Fly; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Finisher (8-10 min):

2-3 sets

Concentration Curl; 8-10 reps/side @21X1

rest 30 sec

2. Barbell Reverse Curl; 8-10 reps @21X1

rest 90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Cat Cow x 5 reps

Childs Pose Lat Stretch x 30 sec/side

Downdog to Updog x 5 reps with 2-3 sec hold in each position

Pigeon Stretch; 30-60 sec/side

Thursday, May 7th, 2026

Week 1 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):

Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION, please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).

Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort

rest 30 sec

x 8 Sets

2-3 Sets

Tall Plank Shoulder Taps x 20/side

30 sec Superman Hold

Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort

rest 30 sec

x 8 Sets

2-3 Sets

Quadruped Plank Shoulder Taps x 20/side

30 sec Swimmer Kicks

Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort

rest 30 sec

x 8 Sets

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):

Front Splits

Supine Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side

Active Straight Leg Raise x 5 reps/side with 5 sec hold

Couch Stretch x 1-2 min/side

Front Split Progression x 10 reps/side

Front Split x 1-2 min/side

Friday, May 8th, 2026

Week 1 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Sumo Deadlift Technique

The sumo deadlift is a hinge variation that targets the glutes without putting excessive stress on the lower back. The wider stance also brings more quad involvement to initiate the lift, which carries over directly to improving your conventional deadlift.

Short on time? Remove Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

3 Sets

15 sec Cardio Sprint

Single Leg DB Glute Bridge; 10 reps/side

Deficit DB Sumo Deadlift; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):

Sumo Deadlift

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 4 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12-15 min):

Goblet Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 10 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 10 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 10 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

E) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets

Suitcase Curtsy Squat; 8 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 60 sec

2. Band Assisted Reverse Nordics; 8-12 @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (8-10 min):

2-3 sets

Wall Sit; 40-60sec

rest 30 sec

2. Hanging Knee Tuck; 10-15 reps @20X0

rest 75-90sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Seal Stretch; 30 sec

Pancake Stretch; 30 sec

Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

Saturday, May 9th, 2026

Week 1 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Spoto Press

Named after one of the greatest bench pressers of all time, the Spoto press targets the weakest point of the bench. Lower the bar with control to about 2–3 inches above the chest, pause for two seconds, then drive back up. The bar never touches the chest.

In a traditional bench press, you get a brief bounce off the chest to help initiate the drive. The Spoto press removes that entirely, making the bottom position much more demanding. Expect to use lighter weights than your normal bench.

Short on time? Remove Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

3 Sets

15 sec Cardio Sprint

Glute Bridge DB Bench Press; 10 reps

Half Kneeling Cable or Band Row; 10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):

Spoto Press

4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 6 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 6 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 22X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12-15 min):

3 sets

Pronated Pull Up Isometric; 15-20sec

rest 15 sec

2. Pronated Strict Pull Up; 5-10 reps @ 21X2

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

The Pull Up isometric is potentiating the regular Pull Ups. The Pull Up isometric should be "heavier" than the regular Pull Up. If you are able to complete 5-10 Tempo Bodyweight Pull Ups, add weight on the Pull Up isometric. If you are using band assistance for the tempo Pull Ups, attempt to perform the Pull Up isometric with bodyweight only.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets

DB Lateral Raise; 10 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 30 sec

2. Yoga Push Up; 6-10 reps

rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Finisher (8-10 min):

2-3 sets

Straddle Weight Plate Front Raise; 10-12 reps @ 30X0

rest 30 sec

2. Weight Plate Russian Twist; 8-10 reps/side

rest 75-90sec and back to 1.

Loading Note;

Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Scorpion Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side

Banded Single Arm Behind the Back Stretch; 30 sec/side

Passive Hang; 30 sec

Sunday, May 10th, 2026

Week 1 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

Your hour in the gym matters, but it's not the whole picture. What you do the rest of the day - how much you move, how often you're on your feet, your general activity - that's a big driver of your results, especially for fat loss.

A lot of people train hard and then sit the other 23 hours. That's a mismatch. You don't need to overhaul your life, but you do need to start paying attention to those small decisions: walking more, taking the stairs, staying a little more active throughout the day. That stuff adds up faster than you think. I always like to ask myself, "where can I steal more movement?"- rather than avoiding it; actively seek it.

Warmly,
Marcus

Pump Lift 4x

Monday, May 4th, 2026

Week 1 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Box Squat

The box squat is one of our primary squat variations this block. The reduced range of motion allows for heavier loads, and we'll decrease reps every other week so you can continue adding weight across the six-week progression.

When selecting box height, aim for about parallel. Lower isn't always better here.

Short on time? Remove Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min):

3 Rounds

90 sec Cardio of Choice

Goblet Heel Sits; 10 reps

Ring Assisted Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side

Dual Kettlebell Rack March; 30 seconds

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):

Box Squat

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 -- 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12-15 min):

Toes Elevated Dumbbell RDL

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

E) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets

Bent Knee Copenhagen Raise; 8 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 60 sec

2. Goblet Cyclist Squat; 8 reps @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (8-10 min):

2-3 sets

Wall Leaning Double Calf Raise; 10-15 reps @ 31X1 Tempo

rest 30 sec

2. Bent Hollow Hold; 20-30sec

rest 30-60 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note;

Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5min):

1-2 sets

Foot Elevated Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side

Dynamic Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side

Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side

Tuesday, May 5th, 2026

Week 1 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Strict Press Progression

This block alternates between the DB strict press and the back supported barbell strict press. Each one enhances the other – the DB press demands more coordination and works each side individually, while the back supported barbell press provides stability so you can prioritize moving heavier loads.

Short on time? Remove Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

3 Sets

Prone BTN Press; 6-8 reps

Ring Y Row; 6-8 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):

Dumbbell Strict Press

4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 15 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 12 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12-15 min):

Incline Prone Dumbbell Row

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 15 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 12 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets

Incline Dumbbell Fly; 10-12 reps @30X0

directly into

2. Incline Dumbbell Bench Press; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

directly into

3. Incline Narrow Grip Bench Press; 10-12 reps @30X0

rest 2min and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

Use the same weight for three movements. Adjust Tempo if needed so that you can use the same weight for all movements.

F) Finisher (8-10 min):

2-3 sets

Concentration Curl; 8-10 reps/side @21X1

rest 30 sec

2. Barbell Reverse Curl; 8-10 reps @21X1

rest 90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Theraband Around the World; 6-10 reps

Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec

PVC Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30-60 sec

Wednesday, May 6th, 2026

Week 1 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work: Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):

Overhead

Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side with 2-3 sec hold

T Spine Can Opener x 1-2 min

Prayer Stretch x 1-2 min

Prone Swimmer x 5 reps with 5 sec hold in the overhead position

Thursday, May 7th, 2026

Week 1 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Sumo Deadlift Technique

The sumo deadlift is a hinge variation that targets the glutes without putting excessive stress on the lower back. The wider stance also brings more quad involvement to initiate the lift, which carries over directly to improving your conventional deadlift.

Short on time? Remove Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

3 Sets

15 sec Cardio Sprint

Single Leg Dumbbell Glute Bridge; 10 reps/side

Deficit Dumbbell Sumo Deadlift; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):

Sumo Deadlift

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 4 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12-15 min):

Goblet Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 10 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 10 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 10 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets

Suitcase Curtsy Squat; 8 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 60 sec

Band Assisted Reverse Nordics; 8-12 @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (8-10 min):

2-3 sets

Wall Sit; 40-60sec

rest 30 sec

Hanging Knee Tuck; 10-15 reps @ 20X0

rest 75-90sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Seal Stretch; 30 sec

Pancake Stretch; 30 sec

Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

Friday, May 8th, 2026

Week 1 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Week 1 — Spoto Press

Named after one of the greatest bench pressers of all time, the Spoto press targets the weakest point of the bench. Lower the bar with control to about 2–3 inches above the chest, pause for two seconds, then drive back up. The bar never touches the chest.

In a traditional bench press, you get a brief bounce off the chest to help initiate the drive. The Spoto press removes that entirely, making the bottom position much more demanding. Expect to use lighter weights than your normal bench.

Short on time? Remove Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

3 Sets

15 sec Cardio Sprint

Glute Bridge Dumbbell Bench Press; 10 reps

Half Kneeling Cable or Band Row; 10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):

Spoto Press

4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 6 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 6 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 22X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12-15 min):

3 sets

Pronated Pull Up Isometric; 15-20sec

rest 15 sec

Pronated Strict Pull Up; 5-10 reps @ 21X2

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

The Pull Up isometric is potentiating the regular Pull Ups. The Pull Up isometric should be "heavier" than the regular Pull Up. If you are able to complete 5-10 Tempo Bodyweight Pull Ups, add weight to the Pull Up isometric. If you are using band assistance for the tempo Pull Ups, attempt to perform the Pull Up isometric with bodyweight only.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets

Dumbbell Lateral Raise; 10 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 30 sec

Yoga Push Up; 6-10 reps

rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Finisher (8-10 min):

2-3 sets

Straddle Weight Plate Front Raise; 10-12 reps @30X0

rest 30 sec

Weight Plate Russian Twist; 8-10 reps/side

rest 75-90sec and back to 1.

Loading Note;

Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Scorpion Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side

Banded Single Arm Behind the Back Stretch; 30 sec/side

Passive Hang; 30 sec

Saturday, May 9th, 2026

Week 1 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (40 min):

Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION, please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).

Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort

rest 30 sec

x 8 Sets

2-3 Sets

Tall Plank Shoulder Taps x 20/side

30 sec Superman Hold

Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort

rest 30 sec

x 8 Sets

2-3 Sets

Quadruped Plank Shoulder Taps x 20/side

30 sec Swimmer Kicks

Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort

rest 30 sec

x 8 Sets

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):

Middle Splits

Half Split Hip Hinge x 5-7 reps/side

Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 2 min

Middle Split x 2 min

Middle Split Hip Hinge x 10 reps

Middle Split Knee Bends x 10 reps

Bottom of Squat Hold x 1-2 min

Sunday, May 10th, 2026

Week 1 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

Your hour in the gym matters, but it's not the whole picture. What you do the rest of the day - how much you move, how often you're on your feet, your general activity - that's a big driver of your results, especially for fat loss.

A lot of people train hard and then sit the other 23 hours. That's a mismatch. You don't need to overhaul your life, but you do need to start paying attention to those small decisions: walking more, taking the stairs, staying a little more active throughout the day. That stuff adds up faster than you think. I always like to ask myself, "where can I steal more movement?"- rather than avoiding it; actively seek it.

Warmly,

Marcus

Pump Lift 3x

Monday, May 4th, 2026

Week 1 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Box Squat

The box squat is one of our primary squat variations this block. The reduced range of motion allows for heavier loads, and we'll decrease reps every other week so you can continue adding weight across the six-week progression.

When selecting box height, aim for about parallel. Lower isn't always better here.

Short on time? Remove Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min):

3 Rounds

90 sec Cardio of Choice

Goblet Heel Sits; 10 reps

Ring Assisted Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side

Dual Kettlebell Rack March; 30 seconds

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):

Box Squat

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 -- 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Intensity 2 (15 min):

Dumbbell Strict Press

4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 15 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 12 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets

Incline Dumbbell Fly; 10-12 reps @ 30X0

directly into

Incline Dumbbell Bench Press; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo
directly into
Incline Narrow Grip Bench Press; 10-12 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 2min and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.
Use the same weight for three movements. Adjust Tempo if needed so that you can use the same weight for all movements.

F) Finisher (8-10 min):

2-3 sets

Concentration Curl; 8-10 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec

Barbell Reverse Curl; 8-10 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5min):

1-2 sets

Foot Elevated Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side

Dynamic Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side

Prayer Stretch; 30-60 sec

Tuesday, May 5th, 2026

Week 1 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work: Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):

Overhead

Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side with 2-3 sec hold

T Spine Can Opener x 1-2 min

Prayer Stretch x 1-2 min

Prone Swimmer x 5 reps with 5 sec hold in the overhead position

Wednesday, May 6th, 2026

Week 1 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Spoto Press

Named after one of the greatest bench pressers of all time, the Spoto press targets the weakest point of the bench. Lower the bar with control to about 2–3 inches above the chest, pause for two seconds, then drive back up. The bar never touches the chest.

In a traditional bench press, you get a brief bounce off the chest to help initiate the drive. The Spoto press removes that entirely, making the bottom position much more demanding. Expect to use lighter weights than your normal bench.

Short on time? Remove Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

3 Sets

15 sec Cardio Sprint

Glute Bridge Dumbbell Bench Press; 10 reps

Half Kneeling Cable or Band Row; 10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):

Spoto Press

4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 6 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 6 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 22X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12-15 min):

3 sets

Pronated Pull Up Isometric; 15-20sec

rest 15 sec

Pronated Strict Pull Up; 5-10 reps @ 21X2

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

The Pull Up isometric is potentiating the regular Pull Ups. The Pull Up isometric should be "heavier" than the regular Pull Up. If you are able to complete 5-10 Tempo Bodyweight Pull Ups,

add weight to the Pull Up isometric. If you are using band assistance for the tempo Pull Ups, attempt to perform the Pull Up isometric with bodyweight only.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets

Bent Knee Copenhagen Raise; 8 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 60 sec

Goblet Cyclist Squat; 8 reps @21X1 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (8-10 min):

2-3 sets

Wall Leaning Double Calf Raise; 10-15 reps @ 31X1 Tempo

rest 30 sec

Bent Hollow Hold; 20-30sec

rest 30-60 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note;

Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30-60sec

Pancake Stretch; 30 sec

Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

Thursday, May 7th, 2026

Week 1 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work: Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):

Front Splits

Supine Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side

Active Straight Leg Raise x 5 reps/side with 5 sec hold
Couch Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Front Split Progression x 10 reps/side
Front Split x 1-2 min/side

Friday, May 8th, 2026

Week 1 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Sumo Deadlift Technique

The sumo deadlift is a hinge variation that targets the glutes without putting excessive stress on the lower back. The wider stance also brings more quad involvement to initiate the lift, which carries over directly to improving your conventional deadlift.

Short on time? Remove Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

3 Sets

15 sec Cardio Sprint

Single Leg Dumbbell Glute Bridge; 10 reps/side

Deficit Dumbbell Sumo Deadlift; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):

Sumo Deadlift

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 4 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12-15 min):

Incline Prone Dumbbell Row

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 15 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 12 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets

Dumbbell Lateral Raise; 10 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 30 sec

Yoga Push Up; 6-10 reps

rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Finisher (8-10 min):

2-3 sets

Wall Sit; 40-60sec

rest 30 sec

Hanging Knee Tuck; 10-15 reps @20X0 Tempo

rest 75-90sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Scorpion Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side

Elevated Pigeon Stretch; 30-60sec/side

Passive Hang; 30 sec

Saturday, May 9th, 2026

Week 1 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (40 min):

Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION, please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).

Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort

rest 30 sec

x 8 Sets

2-3 Sets

Tall Plank Shoulder Taps x 20/side

30 sec Superman Hold

Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 8 Sets
2-3 Sets
Quadruped Plank Shoulder Taps x 20/side
30 sec Swimmer Kicks
Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 8 Sets

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):

Middle Splits
Half Split Hip Hinge x 5-7 reps/side
Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 2 min
Middle Split x 2 min
Middle Split Hip Hinge x 10 reps
Middle Split Knee Bends x 10 reps
Bottom of Squat Hold x 1-2 min

Sunday, May 10th, 2026

Week 1 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

Your hour in the gym matters, but it's not the whole picture. What you do the rest of the day - how much you move, how often you're on your feet, your general activity - that's a big driver of your results, especially for fat loss.

A lot of people train hard and then sit the other 23 hours. That's a mismatch. You don't need to overhaul your life, but you do need to start paying attention to those small decisions: walking more, taking the stairs, staying a little more active throughout the day. That stuff adds up faster than you think. I always like to ask myself, "where can I steal more movement?"- rather than avoiding it; actively seek it.

Warmly,
Marcus

Pump Condition 5x

Monday, May 4th, 2026

Week 1 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Box Squat

The box squat is one of our primary squat variations this block. The reduced range of motion allows for heavier loads, and we'll decrease reps every other week so you can continue adding weight across the six-week progression.

When selecting box height, aim for about parallel. Lower isn't always better here.

Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):

3 Rounds

90 sec Cardio of Choice

Goblet Heel Sits; 10 reps

Ring Assisted Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side

Dual Kettlebell Rack March; 30 seconds

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Box Squat

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):

3 sets

Bent Knee Copenhagen Raise; 8 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 60 sec

2. Toes Elevated DB RDL; 10 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Hinge Conditioning (12 min):

12min As Many Reps As Possible (AMRAP) @85% effort

4 Alternating Single Arm DB Devil Press

6 Alternating DB Power Snatch

10/8 Calories Bike (Male/Female)

Effort Note:

Make sure to use the legs when possible on the DB movements. This will save your low back from fatiguing too quickly.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Foot Elevated Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side

Dynamic Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side

Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side

Tuesday, May 5th, 2026

Week 1 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Strict Press Progression

This block alternates between the DB strict press and the back supported barbell strict press. Each one enhances the other – the DB press demands more coordination and works each side individually, while the back supported barbell press provides stability so you can prioritize moving heavier loads.

Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

3 Sets

Prone BTN Press; 6-8 reps

Ring Y Row; 6-8 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Dumbbell Strict Press

4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 15 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 12 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):

3 sets

Incline DB Fly; 10-12 reps @30X0

directly into

2. Incline DB Bench Press; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

directly into

3. Incline Narrow Grip Bench Press; 10-12 reps @30X0

rest 2min and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

Use the same weight for three movements. Adjust Tempo if needed so that you can use the same weight for all movements.

E) Push Up + Dip Fatigue (12 min):

Every 3mins x 4 Sets

6-8 Strict Bar Dip or Ring Dip

6-8 Dip Support Knee Raise

20/16 Calorie Row (Male/Female)

Effort Note:

The goal is to accumulate as many QUALITY dips as possible. Keep the pace consistent on the Row as this will act as the rest for your upper body pressing muscles.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Theraband Around the World; 6-10 reps

Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec

PVC Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30-60 sec

Wednesday, May 6th, 2026

Week 1 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Density Sets

The strength intensity section uses a high density format – six sets of six reps with only 30–45 seconds of rest. Weight selection is key. Choose a load you could perform for about 12–15 reps when fresh. If you're using Pull Ups, apply the same idea with your level of assistance.

If you start struggling to complete full reps toward the end, that's fine. Continue with partial reps through as much range of motion as you can. That will still produce a very strong stimulus.

Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

+

3 Sets

Banded Goodmorning; 10-15 reps

Dumbbell Chainsaw Row; 6-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

6 sets; rest 30-45sec between sets

Supinated Lat Pulldown or Supinated Strict Pull Up; 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo

Loading Note:

If using Pull Ups instead of pulldowns, match band or machine assistance to prescription. This is a high density format, meaning a lot of reps with little rest. Select a weight or band assistance that is consistent with 12-15 rep max for the prescribed movement.

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):

3 sets

Incline Prone DB Row; 12 reps @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 30 sec

DB Bent Over Reverse Fly; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Fatigued Abdominals (12-15 min):

Every Minute On The Minute (EMOM) x 12-15 sets

Minute 1) 30sec Shuttle Run

Minute 2) 10-15 Russian KB Swings

Minute 3) 10-15 Tuck Ups

Effort Note:

Push the pace on each movement, aiming to leave yourself about 30sec of time to rest before the top of the next minute.

*Shuttle Run: Mark two points 10m apart. 1 rep = there and back.

F) Cooldown (5 minutes):

1-2 sets

Cat Cow x 5 reps

Childs Pose Lat Stretch x 30 sec/side

Downdog to Updog x 5 reps with 2-3 sec hold in each position

Pigeon Stretch; 30-60 sec/side

Thursday, May 7th, 2026

Week 1 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Active Recovery Work (35-40 min):

Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION, please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).

Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort

rest 30 sec

x 8 Sets

2-3 Sets

Tall Plank Shoulder Taps x 20/side

30 sec Superman Hold

Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort

rest 30 sec

x 8 Sets

2-3 Sets

Quadruped Plank Shoulder Taps x 20/side

30 sec Swimmer Kicks

Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort

rest 30 sec

x 8 Sets

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):

Front Splits

Supine Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side

Active Straight Leg Raise x 5 reps/side with 5 sec hold

Couch Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Front Split Progression x 10 reps/side
Front Split x 1-2 min/side

Friday, May 8th, 2026

Week 1 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Sumo Deadlift Technique

The sumo deadlift is a hinge variation that targets the glutes without putting excessive stress on the lower back. The wider stance also brings more quad involvement to initiate the lift, which carries over directly to improving your conventional deadlift.

Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

3 Sets

15 sec Cardio Sprint

Single Leg DB Glute Bridge; 10 reps/side

Deficit DB Sumo Deadlift; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Sumo Deadlift

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 4 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):

3 sets

Suitcase Curtsy Squat; 8 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 60 sec

2. Band Assisted Reverse Nordics; 8-12 @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Single Leg Conditioning (12-15 min):

12mins Continuous Effort

2-4-6-8-10-12.....increase by 2 reps every round

Goblet Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat Right Leg @ 20X0 53/35# (Male/Female)

Goblet Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat Left Leg @ 20X0 53/35#

Wtd or BW Hanging Knee Tucks 20/10#

*5/4 Bike Cals After Every Round

Effort Note:

Pace the bike so that you can make sure to keep quality high on the split squat.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Seal Stretch; 30 sec

Pancake Stretch; 30 sec

Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

Saturday, May 9th, 2026

Week 1 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Spoto Press

Named after one of the greatest bench pressers of all time, the Spoto press targets the weakest point of the bench. Lower the bar with control to about 2–3 inches above the chest, pause for two seconds, then drive back up. The bar never touches the chest.

In a traditional bench press, you get a brief bounce off the chest to help initiate the drive. The Spoto press removes that entirely, making the bottom position much more demanding. Expect to use lighter weights than your normal bench.

Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

+

3 Sets

15 sec Cardio Sprint

Glute Bridge DB Bench Press; 10 reps

Half Kneeling Cable or Band Row; 10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Spoto Press

4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 6 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 6 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 22X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):

3 sets

DB Lateral Raise; 10 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 30 sec

2. Yoga Push Up; 6-10 reps

rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Upper Body Grinder (12-15 min):

3 Sets For Quality

500m Row @ High Effort

10 Neutral Grip Pull Up

60sec KB Farmer's Carry 70/53# (Male/Female)

rest 60-90sec between sets

Effort Note:

Aim for a consistent, steady pace throughout this entire conditioning piece. The goal is only brief pauses as you hit fatigue within the Pull Up and carry.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Scorpion Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side

Banded Single Arm Behind the Back Stretch; 30 sec/side

Passive Hang; 30 sec

Sunday, May 10th, 2026

Week 1 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

Your hour in the gym matters, but it's not the whole picture. What you do the rest of the day - how much you move, how often you're on your feet, your general activity - that's a big driver of your results, especially for fat loss.

A lot of people train hard and then sit the other 23 hours. That's a mismatch. You don't need to overhaul your life, but you do need to start paying attention to those small decisions: walking more, taking the stairs, staying a little more active throughout the day. That stuff adds up faster than you think. I always like to ask myself, "where can I steal more movement?"- rather than avoiding it; actively seek it.

Warmly,
Marcus

Pump Condition 4x

Monday, May 4th, 2026

Week 1 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Box Squat

The box squat is one of our primary squat variations this block. The reduced range of motion allows for heavier loads, and we'll decrease reps every other week so you can continue adding weight across the six-week progression.

When selecting box height, aim for about parallel. Lower isn't always better here.

Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):

3 Rounds

90 sec Cardio of Choice

Goblet Heel Sits; 10 reps

Ring Assisted Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side

Dual Kettlebell Rack March; 30 seconds

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Box Squat

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):

3 sets

Bent Knee Copenhagen Raise; 8 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 60 sec

Toes Elevated Dumbbell RDL; 10 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Hinge Conditioning (12 min):

12min As Many Reps As Possible (AMRAP) @85% effort

4 Alternating Single Arm Dumbbell Devil Press

6 Alternating Dumbbell Power Snatch

10/8 Calories Bike (Male/Female)

Effort Note:

Make sure to use the legs when possible on the DB movements. This will save your low back from fatiguing too quickly.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Foot Elevated Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side

Dynamic Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side

Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side

Tuesday, May 5th, 2026

Week 1 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Strict Press Progression

This block alternates between the DB strict press and the back supported barbell strict press. Each one enhances the other – the DB press demands more coordination and works each side individually, while the back supported barbell press provides stability so you can prioritize moving heavier loads.

Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

3 Sets

Prone BTN Press; 6-8 reps

Ring Y Row; 6-8 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Dumbbell Strict Press

4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 15 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 12 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):

3 sets

Incline Prone Dumbbell Row; 12 reps @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 30 sec

Dumbbell Bent Over Reverse Fly; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Push Up + Dip Fatigue (12 min):

Every 3mins x 4 Sets

6-8 Strict Bar Dip or Ring Dip

6-8 Dip Support Knee Raise

20/16 Calorie Row (Male/Female)

Effort Note:

The goal is to accumulate as many QUALITY dips as possible. Keep the pace consistent on the Row as this will act as the rest for your upper body pressing muscles.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Theraband Around the World; 6-10 reps

Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec

PVC Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30-60 sec

Wednesday, May 6th, 2026

Week 1 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work: Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):

Overhead

Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side with 2-3 sec hold

T Spine Can Opener x 1-2 min

Prayer Stretch x 1-2 min

Prone Swimmer x 5 reps with 5 sec hold in the overhead position

Thursday, May 7th, 2026

Week 1 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Sumo Deadlift Technique

The sumo deadlift is a hinge variation that targets the glutes without putting excessive stress on the lower back. The wider stance also brings more quad involvement to initiate the lift, which carries over directly to improving your conventional deadlift.

Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

3 Sets

15 sec Cardio Sprint

Single Leg Dumbbell Glute Bridge; 10 reps/side

Deficit Dumbbell Sumo Deadlift; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Sumo Deadlift

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 4 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):

3 sets

Suitcase Curtsy Squat; 8 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 60 sec

Band Assisted Reverse Nordics; 8-12 @30X0 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Single Leg Conditioning (12 min):

12mins Continuous Effort

2-4-6-8-10-12.....increase by 2 reps every round

Goblet Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat Right Leg @20X0 53/35# (Male/Female)

Goblet Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat Left Leg @20X0 53/35#

Wtd or BW Hanging Knee Tucks 20/10#

*5/4 Bike Cals After Every Round

Effort Note:

Pace the bike so that you can make sure to keep quality high on the split squat.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Seal Stretch; 30 sec

Pancake Stretch; 30 sec

Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

Friday, May 8th, 2026

Week 1 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Spoto Press

Named after one of the greatest bench pressers of all time, the Spoto press targets the weakest point of the bench. Lower the bar with control to about 2–3 inches above the chest, pause for two seconds, then drive back up. The bar never touches the chest.

In a traditional bench press, you get a brief bounce off the chest to help initiate the drive. The Spoto press removes that entirely, making the bottom position much more demanding. Expect to use lighter weights than your normal bench.

Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

3 Sets

15 sec Cardio Sprint

Glute Bridge Dumbbell Bench Press; 10 reps

Half Kneeling Cable or Band Row; 10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Spoto Press

4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 6 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 6 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 22X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets

Dumbbell Lateral Raise; 10 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 30 sec

Yoga Push Up; 6-10 reps

rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Upper Body Grinder (12-15 min):

3 Sets For Quality

500m Row @ High Effort

10 Neutral Grip Pull Up

60sec Kettlebell Farmer's Carry 70/53# (Male/Female)

rest 60-90sec between sets

Effort Note:

Aim for a consistent, steady pace throughout this entire conditioning piece. The goal is only brief pauses as you hit fatigue within the Pull Up and carry.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Scorpion Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side

Banded Single Arm Behind the Back Stretch; 30 sec/side

Passive Hang; 30 sec

Saturday, May 9th, 2026

Week 1 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (40 min):

Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION, please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).

Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort

rest 30 sec

x 8 Sets

2-3 Sets

Tall Plank Shoulder Taps x 20/side

30 sec Superman Hold

Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort

rest 30 sec

x 8 Sets

2-3 Sets

Quadruped Plank Shoulder Taps x 20/side

30 sec Swimmer Kicks

Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort

rest 30 sec

x 8 Sets

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):

Middle Splits

Half Split Hip Hinge x 5-7 reps/side
Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 2 min
Middle Split x 2 min
Middle Split Hip Hinge x 10 reps
Middle Split Knee Bends x 10 reps
Bottom of Squat Hold x 1-2 min

Sunday, May 10th, 2026

Week 1 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

Your hour in the gym matters, but it's not the whole picture. What you do the rest of the day - how much you move, how often you're on your feet, your general activity - that's a big driver of your results, especially for fat loss.

A lot of people train hard and then sit the other 23 hours. That's a mismatch. You don't need to overhaul your life, but you do need to start paying attention to those small decisions: walking more, taking the stairs, staying a little more active throughout the day. That stuff adds up faster than you think. I always like to ask myself, "where can I steal more movement?" - rather than avoiding it; actively seek it.

Warmly,
Marcus

Pump Condition 3x

Monday, May 4th, 2026

Week 1 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Box Squat

The box squat is one of our primary squat variations this block. The reduced range of motion allows for heavier loads, and we'll decrease reps every other week so you can continue adding weight across the six-week progression.

When selecting box height, aim for about parallel. Lower isn't always better here.

Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):

3 Rounds

90 sec Cardio of Choice

Goblet Heel Sits; 10 reps

Ring Assisted Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side

Dual Kettlebell Rack March; 30 seconds

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Box Squat

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):

3 sets

Dumbbell Lateral Raise; 10 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 30 sec

Dumbbell Strict Press; 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo

rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Push Up + Dip Fatigue (12 min):

Every 3mins x 4 Sets

6-8 Strict Bar Dip or Ring Dip

6-8 Dip Support Knee Raise

20/16 Calorie Row (Male/Female)

Effort Note:

The goal is to accumulate as many QUALITY dips as possible. Keep the pace consistent on the Row as this will act as the rest for your upper body pressing muscles.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Foot Elevated Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side

Dynamic Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side

Prayer Stretch; 30-60 sec

Tuesday, May 5th, 2026

Week 1 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work: Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):

Overhead

Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side with 2-3 sec hold

T Spine Can Opener x 1-2 min

Prayer Stretch x 1-2 min

Prone Swimmer x 5 reps with 5 sec hold in the overhead position

Wednesday, May 6th, 2026

Week 1 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Spoto Press

Named after one of the greatest bench pressers of all time, the Spoto press targets the weakest point of the bench. Lower the bar with control to about 2–3 inches above the chest, pause for two seconds, then drive back up. The bar never touches the chest.

In a traditional bench press, you get a brief bounce off the chest to help initiate the drive. The Spoto press removes that entirely, making the bottom position much more demanding. Expect to use lighter weights than your normal bench.

Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

3 Sets

15 sec Cardio Sprint

Glute Bridge Dumbbell Bench Press; 10 reps

Half Kneeling Cable or Band Row; 10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Spoto Press

4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 6 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 6 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 22X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):

3 sets

Incline Prone Dumbbell Row; 12 reps @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 30 sec

Dumbbell Bent Over Reverse Fly; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Hinge Conditioning (12 min):

12min As Many Reps As Possible (AMRAP) @85% effort

4 Alternating Single Arm Dumbbell Devil Press

6 Alternating Dumbbell Power Snatch

10/8 Calories Bike (Male/Female)

Effort Note:

Make sure to use the legs when possible on the DB movements. This will save your low back from fatiguing too quickly.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30-60sec

Pancake Stretch; 30 sec

Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

Thursday, May 7th, 2026

Week 1 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work: Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):

Front Splits

Supine Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side

Active Straight Leg Raise x 5 reps/side with 5 sec hold

Couch Stretch x 1-2 min/side

Front Split Progression x 10 reps/side

Front Split x 1-2 min/side

Friday, May 8th, 2026

Week 1 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Sumo Deadlift Technique

The sumo deadlift is a hinge variation that targets the glutes without putting excessive stress on the lower back. The wider stance also brings more quad involvement to initiate the lift, which carries over directly to improving your conventional deadlift.

Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

3 Sets

15 sec Cardio Sprint

Single Leg Dumbbell Glute Bridge; 10 reps/side

Deficit Dumbbell Sumo Deadlift; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Sumo Deadlift

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 4 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):

3 sets

Incline Dumbbell Fly; 10-12 reps @ 30X0

directly into

Incline Dumbbell Bench Press; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

directly into

Incline Narrow Grip Bench Press; 10-12 reps @30X0

rest 2min and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

Use the same weight for three movements. Adjust Tempo if needed so that you can use the same weight for all movements.

E) Single Leg Conditioning (12-15 min):

12mins Continuous Effort

2-4-6-8-10-12.....increase by 2 reps every round

Goblet Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat Right Leg @20X0 53/35# (Male/Female)

Goblet Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat Left Leg @20X0 53/35#

Wtd or BW Hanging Knee Tucks 20/10#

*5/4 Bike Cals After Every Round

Effort Note:

Pace the bike so that you can make sure to keep quality high on the split squat.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Scorpion Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side

Elevated Pigeon Stretch; 30-60sec/side

Passive Hang; 30 sec

Saturday, May 9th, 2026

Week 1 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (35-40 min):

Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION, please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).

Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort

rest 30 sec

x 8 Sets

2-3 Sets

Tall Plank Shoulder Taps x 20/side

30 sec Superman Hold

Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort

rest 30 sec

x 8 Sets

2-3 Sets

Quadruped Plank Shoulder Taps x 20/side

30 sec Swimmer Kicks

Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort

rest 30 sec

x 8 Sets

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):

Middle Splits

Half Split Hip Hinge x 5-7 reps/side

Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 2 min

Middle Split x 2 min

Middle Split Hip Hinge x 10 reps

Middle Split Knee Bends x 10 reps

Bottom of Squat Hold x 1-2 min

Sunday, May 10th, 2026

Week 1 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

Your hour in the gym matters, but it's not the whole picture. What you do the rest of the day - how much you move, how often you're on your feet, your general activity - that's a big driver of your results, especially for fat loss.

A lot of people train hard and then sit the other 23 hours. That's a mismatch. You don't need to overhaul your life, but you do need to start paying attention to those small decisions: walking more, taking the stairs, staying a little more active throughout the day. That stuff adds up faster than you think. I always like to ask myself, "where can I steal more movement?"- rather than avoiding it; actively seek it.

Warmly,

Marcus

Perform

Monday, May 4th, 2026

Week 1 Day 1 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Box Squat

The box squat is one of our primary squat variations this block. The reduced range of motion allows for heavier loads, and we'll decrease reps every other week so you can continue adding weight across the six-week progression.

When selecting box height, aim for about parallel. Lower isn't always better here.

Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):

3 Rounds

90 sec Cardio of Choice

Goblet Heel Sits; 10 reps

Ring Assisted Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side

Dual Kettlebell Rack March; 30 seconds

C) Speed Strength - Clean (15min):

1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)

10 Romanian Deadlift

10 Strict Press

10 Front Squat

10 sec Squatting Quad Clean Grip Hold

10 sec Front Rack Hold

10 sec Front Squat Hold

4-5 sets; rest 90-120sec between sets

1 Hang Power Clean + 2 Front Squat + 1 Hang Clean

Sets 1-2: Easy

Set 3-4: Moderate

Set 5: Challenging

*Move with speed and fluidity on the burpee.

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Box Squat

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

E) Strength Balance (10-12 min):

3 sets

Bent Knee Copenhagen Raise; 8 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 60 sec

Toes Elevated Dumbbell RDL; 10 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) High Power Output (12 min):

Every 60 sec x 10-12 sets

10 sec Bike HARD Sprint @ MAX effort

50 sec Easy Pedal (or rest)

Coach Note:

This section of training will progress in the coming weeks. This section aims to learn how to output maximal effort and then teach your body to recover between those bouts.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Foot Elevated Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side

Dynamic Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side

Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side

Tuesday, May 5th, 2026

Week 1 Day 2 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Strict Press Progression

This block alternates between the DB strict press and the back supported barbell strict press. Each one enhances the other – the DB press demands more coordination and works each side

individually, while the back supported barbell press provides stability so you can prioritize moving heavier loads.

Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

3 Sets

Prone BTN Press; 6-8 reps

Ring Y Row; 6-8 reps

C) Dynamic Effort Upper Body:

4 sets

Behind the Neck Split Jerk; 3 reps

rest 30 sec

Plyo Push Up 5-8 reps

rest 90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Increase weight each set prioritizing waking up the nervous system for the heavier work to follow.

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Dumbbell Strict Press

4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 15 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 12 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets

Incline Dumbbell Fly; 10-12 reps @30X0

directly into

Incline Dumbbell Bench Press; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

directly into

Incline Narrow Grip Bench Press; 10-12 reps @30X0

rest 2min and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure. Use the same weight for three movements. Adjust Tempo if needed so that you can use the same weight for all movements.

F) Push Up + Dip Fatigue (12 min):

Every 3mins x 4 Sets

6-8 Strict Bar Dip or Ring Dip

6-8 Dip Support Knee Raise

20/16 Calorie Row (Male/Female)

Effort Note:

The goal is to accumulate as many QUALITY dips as possible. Keep the pace consistent on the Row as this will act as the rest for your upper body pressing muscles.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Theraband Around the World; 6-10 reps

Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec

PVC Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30-60 sec

Wednesday, May 6th, 2026

Week 1 Day 3 - Persist **PERFORM**

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Density Sets

The strength intensity section uses a high density format – six sets of six reps with only 30–45 seconds of rest. Weight selection is key. Choose a load you could perform for about 12–15 reps when fresh. If you're using pull ups, apply the same idea with your level of assistance.

If you start struggling to complete full reps toward the end, that's fine. Continue with partial reps through as much range of motion as you can. That will still produce a very strong stimulus.

Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

3 Sets

Banded Goodmorning; 10-15 reps

Dumbbell Chainsaw Row; 6-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

6 sets; rest 30-45sec between sets

Supinated Lat Pulldown or Supinated Strict Pull Up; 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo

Loading Note:

If using pull ups instead of pulldowns, match band or machine assistance to prescription. This is a high density format, meaning a lot of reps with little rest. Select a weight or band assistance that is consistent with 12-15 rep max for the prescribed movement.

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):

3 sets

Incline Prone Dumbbell Row; 12 reps @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 30 sec

Dumbbell Bent Over Reverse Fly; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Alphabet Soup (28 min):

Every 7mins x 3-4 Sets

A. 15 Russian KBS 70/53# or 53/35# (Male/Female)

B. 50 Double Unders or 100 Single Unders

C. 12-20 Cal Row

D. 12 Burpee over Rower

E. 100m Run

Set 1 - ABCDE

Set 2 - EDCBA

Set 3 - CDEAB

Set 4 - BAEDC

Effort Note: Complete each sequence at a sustainable but honest pace. You'll rotate through a different order each round — read ahead so you know what's coming and can transition without losing time.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Cat Cow x 5 reps

Childs Pose Lat Stretch x 30 sec/side

Downdog to Updog x 5 reps with 2-3 sec hold in each position

Pigeon Stretch; 30-60 sec/side

Thursday, May 7th, 2026

Week 1 Day 4 - Persist PERFORM

A) Active Recovery Work:

Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION, please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).

Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort

rest 30 sec

x 8 Sets

2-3 Sets

Tall Plank Shoulder Taps x 20/side

30 sec Superman Hold

Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort

rest 30 sec

x 8 Sets

2-3 Sets

Quadruped Plank Shoulder Taps x 20/side

30 sec Swimmer Kicks

Run/Bike/Row 30 sec @75% effort

rest 30 sec

x 8 Sets

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:

Front Splits

Supine Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side

Active Straight Leg Raise x 5 reps/side with 5 sec hold

Couch Stretch x 1-2 min/side

Front Split Progression x 10 reps/side

Front Split x 1-2 min/side

Friday, May 8th, 2026

Week 1 Day 5 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Sumo Deadlift Technique

The sumo deadlift is a hinge variation that targets the glutes without putting excessive stress on the lower back. The wider stance also brings more quad involvement to initiate the lift, which carries over directly to improving your conventional deadlift.

Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

3 Sets

15 sec Cardio Sprint

Single Leg Dumbbell Glute Bridge; 10 reps/side

Deficit Dumbbell Sumo Deadlift; 10 reps

C) Speed Strength - Snatch (15 min):

Barbell Warm-up:

1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)

10 Snatch Grip Romanian Deadlift

10 BTN Snatch Press or BTN Snatch Push Press

10 Overhead Squat

10 sec Squatting Quad Snatch Grip Hold

10 sec Snatch Grip Overhead Hold

10 sec Overhead Squat Hold

Every 2:00 x 5 sets

2 Hang Snatch High Pull + 2 Hang Power Snatch + 2 Overhead Squat

rest until the next 2:00

Sets 1-2: Easy

Set 3-4: Moderate

Set 5: Challenging

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Sumo Deadlift

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 4 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (10-12 min):

3 sets

Suitcase Curtsy Squat; 8 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 60 sec

Band Assisted Reverse Nordics; 8-12 @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Interval Weight Training:

3 Sets x 3 min As Many Reps As Possible (AMRAP)

300/240m Row (Male/Female)

18 Wall Ball 20/14# to 10/9' Target

12 Dumbbell Suitcase Walk Lunge 50/35# or 35/20#

in remaining time:

Russian Box Step Up

rest 2mins between sets

Effort Note:

If you complete 3 sets and your movement quality is high, you have energy, and you have time, complete the 4th and final set. Otherwise, call it a day and be PROUD of your work.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Seal Stretch; 30 sec

Pancake Stretch; 30 sec

Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

Saturday, May 9th, 2026

Week 1 Day 6 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Spoto Press

Named after one of the greatest bench pressers of all time, the Spoto press targets the weakest point of the bench. Lower the bar with control to about 2–3 inches above the chest, pause for two seconds, then drive back up. The bar never touches the chest.

In a traditional bench press, you get a brief bounce off the chest to help initiate the drive. The Spoto press removes that entirely, making the bottom position much more demanding. Expect to use lighter weights than your normal bench.

Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

3 Sets

15 sec Cardio Sprint

Glute Bridge Dumbbell Bench Press; 10 reps

Half Kneeling Cable or Band Row; 10 reps/side

C) Hot Start (9-12 min):

Every 60 sec x 9-12 sets

Min 1) DB Push Press; 10 reps

Min 2) Hanging Knee Raise; 10-15 reps

Min 3) Bike 8-10 Cals (faster each set)

Effort Note: This section is meant to gradually increase the heart rate and prep the upper body to be firing before the heavier work to follow.

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Spoto Press

4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 6 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 6 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 22X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (10-12 min):

3 sets

Dumbbell Lateral Raise; 10 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 30 sec

Yoga Push Up; 6-10 reps

rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Upper Functional Pump Conditioning (12 min):

12min As Many Reps As Possible (AMRAP)

2-4-6-8-10-12-14....

Strict C2B Pull-Up or Strict Pull-Up or Body Row

Feet Anchored Sit Up

*25 Double Unders or 50 Single Unders after each round

Effort Note: For 12mins continue to accumulate as many rounds as possible. In each round, the repetitions increase by 2.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Scorpion Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side

Banded Single Arm Behind the Back Stretch; 30 sec/side

Passive Hang; 30 sec

Sunday, May 10th, 2026

Week 1 Day 7 - Persist PERFORM

Your hour in the gym matters, but it's not the whole picture. What you do the rest of the day - how much you move, how often you're on your feet, your general activity - that's a big driver of your results, especially for fat loss.

A lot of people train hard and then sit the other 23 hours. That's a mismatch. You don't need to overhaul your life, but you do need to start paying attention to those small decisions: walking more, taking the stairs, staying a little more active throughout the day. That stuff adds up faster than you think. I always like to ask myself, "where can I steal more movement?"- rather than avoiding it; actively seek it.

Warmly,
Marcus

Minimalist

Monday, May 4th, 2026

Week 1 Day 1 - Persist Minimalist

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Goblet Squat

The goblet squat is one of our primary squat variations this block. The heavy counterbalance weight allows for high quality squat positions. We'll decrease reps every other week so you can continue adding weight across the six-week progression.

Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):

3 Rounds

90 sec Cardio of Choice

Goblet Heel Sits; 10 reps

Ring Assisted Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side

Dual Kettlebell Rack March; 30 seconds

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

DB Goblet Squat

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):

3 sets

Bent Knee Copenhagen Raise; 8 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 60 sec

Toes Elevated Dumbbell RDL; 10 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Hinge Conditioning (12 min):

12min As Many Reps As Possible (AMRAP) @85% effort

4 Alternating Single Arm Dumbbell Devil Press

6 Alternating Dumbbell Power Snatch

100m Run

Effort Note:

Make sure to use the legs when possible on the DB movements. This will save your low back from fatiguing too quickly.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Foot Elevated Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side

Dynamic Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side

Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side

Tuesday, May 5th, 2026

Week 1 Day 2 - Persist Minimalist

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Strict Press Progression

This block alternates between the DB strict press and the alternating DB press. Each one enhances the other – the DB press allows for more load, while the alternating press requires more core stability.

Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

3 Sets

Prone BTN Press; 6-8 reps

Ring Y Row; 6-8 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Dumbbell Strict Press

4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 15 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 12 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):

3 sets

Incline Prone Dumbbell Row; 12 reps @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 30 sec

Dumbbell Bent Over Reverse Fly; 10-12 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Push Up + Dip Fatigue (12 min):

Every 3mins x 4 Sets

6-8 Strict Bar Dip or Ring Dip

6-8 Dip Support Knee Raise

150-200m Run

Effort Note:

The goal is to accumulate as many QUALITY dips as possible. Keep the pace consistent on the Run as this will act as the rest for your upper body pressing muscles.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Theraband Around the World; 6-10 reps

Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec

PVC Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30-60 sec

Wednesday, May 6th, 2026

Week 1 Day 3 - Persist Minimalist

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):

Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (8-10 min):

Overhead

Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side with 2-3 sec hold

T Spine Can Opener x 1-2 min

Prayer Stretch x 1-2 min

Prone Swimmer x 5 reps with 5 sec hold in the overhead position

Thursday, May 7th, 2026

Week 1 Day 4 - Persist Minimalist

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Sumo Deadlift Technique

The sumo deadlift is a hinge variation that targets the glutes without putting excessive stress on the lower back. The wider stance also brings more quad involvement to initiate the lift, which carries over directly to improving your conventional deadlift.

Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

3 Sets

15 sec Cardio Sprint

Single Leg Dumbbell Glute Bridge; 10 reps/side

Deficit Dumbbell Sumo Deadlift; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Dumbbell Sumo Deadlift

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 10 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10-12 min):

3 sets

Suitcase Curtsy Squat; 8 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo

rest 60 sec

Band Assisted Reverse Nordics; 8-12 @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Single Leg Conditioning (10 min):

10mins Continuous Effort

2-4-6-8-10-12.....increase by 2 reps every round

Goblet Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat Right Leg @20X0 53/35# (Male/Female)

Goblet Rear Foot Elevated Split Squat Left Leg @20X0 53/35#

Wtd or BW Hanging Knee Tucks 20/10#

Effort Note:

Keep quality high each movement acts as a brief rest for the other movement.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Seal Stretch; 30 sec

Pancake Stretch; 30 sec

Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

Friday, May 8th, 2026

Week 1 Day 5 - Persist Minimalist

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Supinated Grip DB Bench Press

The supinated (underhand) grip dumbbell bench press is a shoulder-friendly exercise designed to reduce joint stress while heavily targeting the upper chest, triceps, and anterior deltoids. By using an underhand grip, the shoulders are naturally kept in external rotation and elbows tucked, offering a superior stretch for the pectorals.

Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

3 Sets

15 sec Cardio Sprint

Glute Bridge Dumbbell Bench Press; 10 reps

Half Kneeling Cable or Band Row; 10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):

Supinated Grip Dumbbell Bench Press

4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 8 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 8 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 8 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 22X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets

Dumbbell Lateral Raise; 10 reps @ 30X0 Tempo

rest 30 sec

Yoga Push Up; 6-10 reps

rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Upper Body Grinder (12-15 min):

3 Sets For Quality

400m Run

10-15 Pull Up

60sec Dumbbell Farmer's Carry 70/50# (Male/Female)

rest 60-90sec between sets

Effort Note:

Aim for a consistent, steady pace throughout this entire conditioning piece. The goal is only brief pauses as you hit fatigue within the pull up and carry.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

Scorpion Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side

Banded Single Arm Behind the Back Stretch; 30 sec/side

Passive Hang; 30 sec

Saturday, May 9th, 2026

Week 1 Day 6 - Persist Minimalist

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):

Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):

Front Splits

Supine Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side

Active Straight Leg Raise x 5 reps/side with 5 sec hold

Couch Stretch x 1-2 min/side

Front Split Progression x 10 reps/side

Front Split x 1-2 min/side

Sunday, May 10th, 2026

Week 1 Day 7 - Persist Minimalist

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A lot of people train hard and then sit the other 23 hours. That's a mismatch. You don't need to overhaul your life, but you do need to start paying attention to those small decisions: walking more, taking the stairs, staying a little more active throughout the day. That stuff adds up faster than you think. I always like to ask myself, "where can I steal more movement?"- rather than avoiding it; actively seek it.

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Marcus